



Financial Benefits Summary

Assured Income for the Severely Handicapped (AISH)

This fact sheet summarizes financial benefits that may be provided to eligible clients through the AISH program. Eligibility and amounts are governed by the *Assured Income for the Severely Handicapped Act* and regulations and are subject to change. See the AISH Program Policy manual for further clarification and updates.

Four-digit computer codes are listed for the administration of benefits.

Core Benefits

Core benefits consist of the following:

- **Living Allowance (Code 1601):** To assist clients living in the community.
- **Modified Living Allowance (Code 1616):** Consisting of a personal allowance and an accommodation rate to assist clients living in a facility.
 - * The accommodation room rate charges are established under the *Continuing Care Act*.
- **Child Benefit (Code 1609):** To assist with the costs associated with raising dependent children.

Monthly Core Benefits	
Living Allowance (Code 1601)	\$1,940.00
Modified Living Allowance - Personal Allowance (Code 1616)	\$373.00
Child Benefit (Code 1609)	\$232.00 first child \$117.00 each additional child

Income Exemptions

Income is used to determine eligibility for the AISH program and the amount of living allowance or modified living allowance. AISH recognizes a mutual obligation of cohabiting partners to support each other. Therefore, income of the applicant/client and their cohabiting partner is considered in determining eligibility and level of benefits.

Employment Income Exemption

- Single: up to \$1,072 is fully exempt and up to \$2,009 is 50% exempt up to a maximum exemption of \$1,541 per month
- Family: up to \$2,612 is fully exempt and up to \$3,349 is 50% exempt up to a maximum exemption of \$2,981 per month

Passive Business and Spousal Pension Income Exemption

- Single: up to \$300 is fully exempt and the remaining is 25% exempt
- Family: up to \$875 is fully exempt and the remaining is 25% exempt

More Information about the AISH Program

The AISH program provides financial and health benefits to eligible adult Albertans with a permanent medical condition that prevents them from earning a living.

Website:

For more information about the AISH Program click: alberta.ca/aish

Your Guide to AISH:

Your Guide to AISH includes general information about the AISH program and benefits. To access Your Guide to AISH click: open.alberta.ca/publications/9781460136607

AISH Program Policy Manual:

To access the AISH Program Policy online policy manual click: manuals.alberta.ca/aish-policy-manual

Contact:

To find the phone number and address of an AISH office click: alberta.ca/contact-aish

Effective January 1, 2026

Emergency Benefits

Assists clients with costs for reasonable and essential goods and services in an emergency situation that is beyond the client's control.

Accommodation (Code 1843)

Actual cost

Child Care (Code 2052)

Actual cost

Damage Deposit (Code 2053)

Up to \$414.00 for clients (and cohabiting partners) without dependent children
Up to \$1,177.00 for clients with children
*Available once every 3 years

Rental Arrears (Code 2054)

Same as damage deposit rates

Food (Code 2051)

Up to \$26.00 per day per client
Up to \$20.00 per day per dependent child

Home or Appliance Repairs (Code 2051)

Actual cost

Replacement Clothing (Code 2051)

Up to \$253.00 per client
Up to \$190.00 per dependent child

Transportation (Code 1844)

Actual cost

Utility Arrears (Code 2050)

Actual cost

Other Goods and Services (Code 2052)

Actual cost up to \$1,177.00

Asset Exemptions

Assets are used to determine eligibility for the AISH program.

The total market value of all non-exempt assets cannot be worth more than **\$100,000** to be eligible for AISH.

Other Resources

Canada Child Benefit (CCB)

The CCB is paid monthly from July to June and is based on previous year's income.

See: canada.ca/en/revenue-agency/services/child-family-benefits/canada-child-benefit-overview

Alberta Child and Family Benefit (ACFB)

The ACFB is paid quarterly. Eligibility is based on annual income and the number of dependants living in the household.

See: alberta.ca/alberta-child-and-family-benefit

Canada Workers Benefit (CWB)

CWB is paid quarterly beginning in April and based on the previous year's income.

See: canada.ca/en/revenue-agency/services/child-family-benefits/canada-workers-benefit

Personal Benefits (Partial List)

AISH provides personal benefits to assist clients with specific one-time or ongoing expenses over and above the monthly living allowance or modified living allowance. Personal benefits may also be provided to clients to help offset costs associated with their dependent children.

Child Care - Day Care or Licensed Family Day Home (Code 1613)

Parent portion of subsidized rate per dependent child
Actual cost of deposit or application fees

Child Care - Private Child Care (Code 1613)

Actual cost up to \$9.00 per hour for the first dependent child
\$6.00 per hour for each additional child up to \$15.00 per hour

Children’s School Expenses (Code 2002)

\$63.00 for each child 4 years or older in kindergarten or preschool
\$121.00 for each child in grades 1 to 6
\$208.00 for each child in grades 7 to 12

Children’s School Expenses - School Lunch Supervision (Code 2002)

Actual Cost

Employment and Training Supports (Code 2020)

Actual cost up to \$590.00 per 12-month period

Escaping Abuse

Establishing New Residence (2040): \$1,177.00
Moving Benefit (Code 2041): Actual cost
Damage Deposit (2042): Actual cost

Community Start-Up (Code 2010)

Actual cost up to \$1,177.00

Infant Care (Code 2003)

One-time payment of \$296.00 per infant

Moving (Codes 2045, 2046 or 2047)

Actual cost

Prenatal Needs Benefit (Code 1640)

\$117.00 per month starting at 14 weeks of pregnancy

Remote Community (Code 1614)

\$48.00 per month, per client and per dependent child

Service Animal (Code 1615)

\$63.00 per month

Travel - Transportation (Codes 2031, 1611, 2032, 1612 or 2030)

Actual cost of the most economical means of public transportation or \$0.37 per km for a private vehicle or the actual cost of taxi fare

Travel - Accommodation (Codes 2031, 1611, 2032, 1612 or 2030)

Actual Cost

Travel - Food (Codes 2031, 1611, 2032, 1612 or 2030)

See: Emergency Food

Health Benefits

AISH clients also receive health benefits for themselves, their spouses and their dependants, unless they receive coverage through the federal government or full coverage from their employer.

AISH health benefits cover basic dental care, eye exams and glasses, prescriptions, essential diabetic supplies and emergency ambulance services.

AISH also covers ambulance trips to the closest emergency room.

Personal Benefits Eligibility Criteria

The AISH program may provide personal benefits to help clients with one-time or ongoing expenses over and above their monthly living allowance when:

- The client and their cohabiting partner have no more than \$5,000 in non-exempt assets or are in a situation of financial hardship;
- The requested item is considered necessary;
- The client is not eligible to receive the same or similar benefit from another program or source; and
- In the case of medical equipment and supplies, the benefit is essential to manage the client’s condition.

Funeral Benefits (Codes 1970, 1971, 1975, 1976)

Funeral expenses for burial/cremation in Alberta: Up to \$4,601.00 and, as necessary:

Embalming: Up to \$781.00

Funeral Ceremony: Up to \$1,041.00

Transportation costs when over 20km outside the provider’s municipality: Up to \$1.13 per km

Required Cemetery Expenses: Reasonable cost

Transport remains to another province/territory:

Reasonable cost

Special Goods and Services

Special Goods and Services are a type of personal benefit provided to assist clients with the costs of specific medically required or disability related goods and services.

Medical Equipment (Various Codes)

Actual reasonable cost up to \$2,351.00

Maintenance of Equipment - Manual Wheelchair (Code 2066)

Up to \$519.00 per 12-month period for maintenance and repairs

Maintenance of Equipment - Power Wheelchair/ Scooter (Code 2066)

Up to \$692.00 per 12-month period for maintenance and repairs

Medical Supplies (Codes 1660 or 2060)

Actual reasonable cost up to \$473.00 per month

Medical Alert Services (Code 2068 or 1698)

Actual reasonable cost of initial set up and ongoing fees

Special Diet (Code 1610)

Low Sodium: \$26.00 per month

Low Cholesterol or Low Fat: \$26.00 per month

High Fibre: \$26.00 per month

High Calcium: \$26.00 per month

High Protein: \$26.00 per month

Lactose Free: \$26.00 per month

Low or High Potassium: \$26.00 per month

Pregnancy: \$32.00 per month

Breastfeeding: \$37.00 per month for up to 12 months

High Calorie: \$44.00 per month

AIDS or HIV: \$44.00 per month

Hepatitis C: \$44.00 per month

Heart Healthy: \$48.00 per month

Diabetes: \$48.00 per month

Milk Free: \$63.00 per month

Celiac or Gluten Free: \$95.00 per month

Renal Failure or Insufficiency: \$132.00 per month

Specialized Clothing (Code 2021)

Actual reasonable cost up to \$354.00 in a 12-month period